



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

Minutes of the Meeting
Monday, June 15, 2026, 7:00 PM
at the Town Hall, 1 South Road

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:02 PM.

PRESENT: Bronstein, Johndrow. Absent: Milikowsky.

Also present: Douglas Finn, Others as noted.

Public Comment

Public are invited to comment on any item NOT on the agenda.

No comments offered.

Discussion - Farming Activity at 0 Main Road

Board will consider complaints received about farming activity at 0 Main Road, Assessors Parcel 29-9-61-B.

Ms. Bronstein established rules for participation, reminding participants that comments should be directed to the board only, with no crosstalk permitted.

Mr. Shaw asked that, for future reference, any discussion relative to properties without a street number should be referenced as “adjacent to” a given lot.

Mr. Mike Stacy presented exhibits that claim that Massachusetts laws require piles of chicken manure to be covered if left in one place for more than seven days, and that use of chicken manure on field where leaching into a water supply was prohibited. Mr. Stacy noted further that if left in an area where it could leach into the watershed.

Mr. Mike Matrishion expressed concerns about the odor, which he reported lasted about two weeks.

Mr. Aaron Bauer, owner of the property, noted that the field has always been fertilized using animal waste; he noted that application of fertilizer was within the rights of the landowner under the zoning bylaw.

Mr. John Shaw: We are a farm community. Many farms in town spread manure as fertilizer, because commercial fertilizer is prohibitively expensive. Mr. Shaw noted that whatever type of manure was spread, it is common practice in Westhampton. Mr. Shaw suggested that the complaint was frivolous, and encroached on a person’s right to use their land as a farmland.

Mr. John Kahane, 343 Main Road: I disagree that the complaint is frivolous. I recognize that we are a farm community; however, we are a residential community. Without getting into an argument, this matter should be dealt with calmly. It’s important to be considerate. “I’m from the Bronx – I know nothing about farming.” Mr. Kahane further noted that consideration – keeping neighbors advised as to what you’re doing to allow consideration as to how best to manage matters. He noted that this was not the first time that manure has been used on the property as a fertilizer. He asked whether any members of the board were on site to smell the

odor.

Mr. Stacy noted that the odor was offensive, placed on a 'road'¹ for a period of time, and left uncovered.

Mr. Shaw noted that larger farms stockpile and compost manure uncovered.

Mr. Stacy suggested that manure was one thing, but chicken manure is another thing.

Mr. Matrishion provided references to state regulations include: 330 CMR 31.00 and 313 CMR 11.09

Mr. Johndrow noted Chapter 11, Section 125A specifically protects and allows the distribution of manure as a fertilizer on agricultural lands.

Mr. Matrishion noted that the manure was brought in from another town.

Mr. Bauer expressed concern that he was being personally attacked, and that several other farmers had expressed support for the continued agricultural use of the property.

Selectboard took the matter under advisement, stating that they would refer the matter to the Agricultural Commission. No further action taken.

Reports from Town Boards, Committees or Departments

The Selectboard will receive and act on any reports or presentations. Votes may be taken.

Mr. Steve Holt noted that the previous agenda item reinforced the need for a strong agricultural commission, and asked about the current membership.

Ms. Meaghan Schwelm: Ms. Schwelm asked about the finance committee meeting and whether there was any impact to the library budget. Mr. Holt: The library was not discussed.

Ms. Schwelm thanked the board for the information.

Review / Approve Contract: Pine Island Lake Culvert Rehabilitation Project

Selectboard will review contract, and may vote to approve / execute.

Mr. Finn presented the project – a proposal to resleeve a municipally owned culvert under Reservoir Road adjacent to the west end of Pine Island Lake. Mr. Finn explained the scope of the work, and the intention of the contract.

After review, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

To approve and to sign.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (7:40 PM)

Review / Approve Veterans Services Memorandum of Understanding (MOU)

Selectboard will review MOU, and may vote to approve / execute.

Ms. Bronstein noted that the item had been completed. No action required.

Social Media Policy Review

Selectboard will review a proposed policy for municipal use of electronic social media. Votes may be taken.

Ms. Bronstein stated that further review is necessary, and recommended tabling the matter to the next regular meeting. Johndrow concurred.

Approval and Launch of official Westhampton Social Media Page

Selectboard will review proposed municipal social media page.

Pending approval of the social media policy, the board agreed to table the matter to a later meeting; also to allow the full board to review.

Assignment of Public Posting Location

Selectboard will consider a proposal to designate the town municipal website as the official posting location for public notices, in accordance with 920 CMR 29.0.03(2). Votes may be taken.

Mr. Finn explained the proposal – to make the town’s website the primary posting location for all public notices.

There were many comments and questions about the proposal. After some discussion, the board took no action and tabled the matter to a later date. Mr. Finn will research and provide a cost for the placement of a new ‘public notices’ cabinet to be placed on the north exterior wall of the Town Hall as an alternate posting location.

Reappointments

Board will review and discuss potential reappointments of board and committee members, as well as staff. No action anticipated.

Mr. Johndrow suggested that an affirmative response from all reappointments be requested to affirmatively respond by June 29. Mr. Finn will give notice.

Election/Override Post Mortem

Board will review election results and Finance Committee recommendations for the continuance of Town Meeting. Votes may be taken.

The recommendations of the finance committee were reviewed, with no specific action taken. Mr. Ben Warren was present, and the board reviewed with him the anticipated process for resumption of the town meeting.

Administrative Matters

Town Coordinator Update

Mr. Finn noted for the record that he had submitted his resignation from the position of Town Coordinator, with his last day to be July 10, 2026. The position has been posted in several locations, and there have been a few inquiries.

Mr. Finn noted that the closing for the Tob Hill Road parcels will be on Wednesday, June 17, and that all seemed in order.

Review and Act on any Correspondence

Correspondence was reviewed. The board took no action on any given item.

Review and approval of minutes of past meetings

Minutes of June 1, 2026 were reviewed. It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein,

To approve the minutes as presented and amended.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (8:05 PM)

Review and approval of AP and Payroll Warrants (W26-25)

Warrants were reviewed. Mr. Finn noted that Warrant #W26-25 SUP was exclusively for expenses related to the Landscape Partnership Grant, and the purchase of land on Tob Hill Road. Mr. Finn also followed up on Ms. Milikowsky's request in regard to the PSC loan, that it is being paid via W26-25.

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein,

To approve A/P Warrant #W26-25 and Payroll Warrant #WP26-25 as presented.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (8:07 PM)

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky,

To approve Warrant #W26-25 SUP as presented.

VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (8:08 PM)

Member Concerns

Board may discuss new topics raised by individual members, deliberate on potential action or future agenda placement, or give direction to staff.

No new concerns raised.

New Business / Public Comment

Mr. Steve Malinowski, 41 North Road (who arrived to the meeting late) made a request, under [M.G.L. c. 66, § 10](#), for the total amount spent by the town "for legal services related to the 'triangle' matter raised some years ago." Mr. Finn stated that he would research and provide the information if available.

ADJOURN

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

To adjourn.

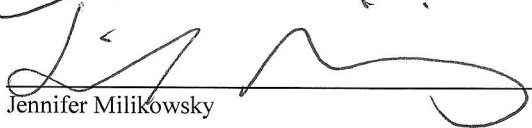
VOTED: 2, 0, 0. (8:10 PM)

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard on June 29, 2026.



Susan Bronstein



Scott Johndrow

Jennifer Milikowsky